

Escalation Memo 01

ESCALATION MEMORANDUM

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TO: Chief Information Officer
FROM: Mark Johnson, Infrastructure Project Manager
DATE: May 27, 2026
SUBJECT: CRITICAL ESCALATION - Data Lake Project Infrastructure Blockage

PRIORITY: CRITICAL

ESCALATION LEVEL: CIO

PROJECT INFORMATION

Project Name: Data Lake Implementation
Project ID: DLI-2024-095
Sponsor: Susan Clark, Chief Data Officer
Current Status: BLOCKED

ESCALATION REASON

The Data Lake Implementation project is completely blocked due to critical infrastructure dependencies that cannot be resolved through normal project management channels. The Cloud Infrastructure Team is unable to meet provisioning timelines due to severe capacity constraints and competing priorities across multiple enterprise projects.

CRITICAL ISSUES

1. Cloud Infrastructure Team Capacity Crisis
 - Team unable to provision virtual network configuration (5 weeks delayed)
 - Storage tier provisioning blocked by IT Finance Committee (3 weeks delayed)
 - Compute cluster setup blocked awaiting network configuration (2 weeks delayed)
 - Multiple projects competing for same limited infrastructure resources
 - No resolution path through normal channels
2. IT Finance Committee Blocking Storage Costs
 - Storage cost approval stalled due to budget concerns
 - Competing priorities for Q3 funding
 - No clear decision timeline
 - Project cannot proceed without storage capacity
3. Cloud Provider Capacity Constraints
 - Primary region at 85% capacity

- Provider unable to guarantee capacity for our requirements
- May require multi-region architecture
- Significant cost and timeline implications

IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Business Impact:

- Project timeline indefinite delay
- Business stakeholders losing confidence
- \$2.5M investment at risk
- Dependent projects blocked
- Data strategy objectives at risk

Financial Impact:

- Project budget 60% utilized with no progress
- Team resources idle while blocked
- Potential budget reallocation decision pending
- Additional costs for alternative approaches

Timeline Impact:

- Original completion date: September 30, 2026
- Current projected delay: 6+ months
- No clear path to resolution

ATTEMPTED RESOLUTIONS

1. Project team level: Resource requests submitted, no response
2. Department level: Escalated to IT Director, no resolution
3. Cross-department coordination: Attempted, competing priorities unresolved
4. Vendor engagement: External consultants engaged, but infrastructure dependency remains

REQUESTED ACTION

IMMEDIATE CIO INTERVENTION REQUIRED:

1. Resolve Cloud Infrastructure Team capacity constraints
 - Prioritize Data Lake infrastructure provisioning
 - Allocate additional resources or restructure team
 - Establish clear timeline for completion
2. Unblock IT Finance Committee approval
 - Executive decision on storage cost approval

- Clear budget allocation for project completion
 - Decision timeline: Within 5 business days
3. Address cloud provider capacity constraints
 - Executive-level engagement with cloud provider
 - Decision on multi-region approach
 - Budget approval for alternative architecture
 4. Project viability assessment
 - Decision on project continuation vs. cancellation
 - Resource reallocation if project cancelled
 - Communication to stakeholders

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

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1. Emergency meeting with CIO, CDO, CFO, and IT Director within 48 hours
 2. Executive decision on infrastructure prioritization
 3. Clear timeline for resolution
 4. Regular executive status updates until resolution

CONTACT INFORMATION

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CC: Susan Clark (Chief Data Officer), IT Director, Project Management Office

This escalation requires immediate executive attention to prevent project failure and significant financial loss.